

Speaker 4 of 5 — Data Analysis 1: Market & Pay

Career Compass SG · Module 1 Assignment · Group 7

Your slot: 6:00 – 8:00 (2 minutes) · You deliver the first half of the findings

Your job in one sentence

Answer "where are the jobs and what do they pay" — and then break the assumption that those are the same question. Your section is what forced the whole product design, so land the independence point clearly; Speaker 5 builds directly on it.

Where you sit in the flow

	Speaker	Topic
	1	Dashboard overview
	2	Technology stack
	3	Data cleaning
→ YOU	4	Data analysis 1 — market & pay
	5	Data analysis 2 — competition, skills & scoring

Speaker 3 hands you: "...so that's the data we trust. Here's what it actually says." You hand to Speaker 5 with: "Volume and pay are two of the four dimensions. The other two are where it gets interesting."

Framing rule: every finding is a **sentence**, not a chart. Say the sentence, then point at the evidence. Never say "as you can see here".

Script

Part A — Where the jobs are is not where the money is (6:00 – 6:45)

(Slide: the two-panel chart — postings on the left, median pay on the right, same row order)

Two panels, same twelve categories, same order. Left: **how many postings**. Right: **what they pay**. If size and pay moved together these would be the same shape. **They're not**.

- **Admin / Secretarial is the third-largest category** — 117,854 postings — and among the worst paid at **\$2,900**, against a market median of \$3,850.
- **IT is the only large category that's both biggest and best paid** — 140,866 postings at **\$6,500**. The exception, not the rule.

Where the jobs are and where the money is are different questions. That's why we score four dimensions instead of one.

Part B — What an average hides (6:45 – 7:10)

(Slide: the salary histogram with both lines marked)

One note on how we report pay. The distribution is **right-skewed** — **skew 1.95**. The **mean is \$4,674**; the **median is \$3,850**. That \$800 gap means the mean describes almost nobody.

So every headline figure we publish is a median, and this chart shows both lines so you can see why.

Part C — What experience is actually worth (7:10 – 7:50)

(Slide: the seniority ladder + the IT experience curve)

Now the question a switcher actually asks: **what does moving up buy me?**

Level	Median
Entry	\$2,675
Junior	\$3,150
Mid	\$4,000
Senior	\$5,000
Management	\$6,500

Entry to Management is a 2.4× multiple — but the rate of climb varies hugely by field. In **IT**, each extra year of required experience is worth about **\$908 a month** — \$3,100 at zero years, **\$14,000 at twelve**.

One surprise: **part-time pays a 36% discount**, \$2,500 against \$3,900 permanent. But **contract pays more than permanent, at \$4,250**. A contract isn't automatically a pay cut.

Part D — Handover (7:50 – 8:00)

Volume and pay are two of our four dimensions, and they already disagree. **The other two are where it gets interesting.**

Numbers you must know cold

Figure	Value
Market median / mean / skew	\$3,850 / \$4,674 / 1.95
Quartiles	\$2,950 (p25) – \$5,500 (p75)
Best-paid sizeable category	Information Technology, \$6,500 (140,866 postings)
Worst-paid sizeable category	General Work, \$2,650 (30,140 postings)
Third-largest category	Admin / Secretarial, 117,854 postings, \$2,900
Seniority ladder	2,675 → 3,150 → 4,000 → 5,000 → 6,500
IT return on experience	~\$908/month per year ; \$3,100 at 0 yrs → \$14,000 at 12
Part-time vs permanent	\$2,500 vs \$3,900 — a 36% discount
Contract	\$4,250 — above permanent

Backup figures

Top 5 best-paying categories (≥ 2,000 postings)

Category	Postings	Median
Information Technology	140,866	\$6,500
Risk Management	9,390	\$6,000
Banking and Finance	62,000	\$5,500
Consulting	38,961	\$4,750
Insurance	7,994	\$4,750

Five largest categories

Category	Postings	Median
Information Technology	140,866	\$6,500
Engineering	136,372	\$4,250
Admin / Secretarial	117,854	\$2,900
Customer Service	111,785	\$3,100
Sales / Retail	105,067	\$3,600

Questions you own

"Are these salaries reliable? Employers exaggerate."

These are advertised bands, not offers — we say that explicitly. What makes them usable is volume and consistency: 99% of a million postings disclose a band, and we're comparing categories against each other on the same measure, so any systematic advertising bias largely cancels out.

"Why medians everywhere?"

Skew of 1.95. The mean is \$4,674 against a \$3,850 median — the mean sits above what most people would actually be offered.

"Isn't the experience curve just seniority relabelled?"

They're different fields — `minimumYearsExperience` is a number in the posting, `positionLevels` is a category. They correlate, but the curve lets us price a *year*, which the seniority band can't.

"Category shares don't add to 100% — why?"

A posting can belong to up to three categories; the average is 1.69. Shares overlap by design, and we say so on the dashboard.

"Why is Admin so big and so badly paid — is that not just Singapore?"

It's a large, low-barrier category: 57.5% of its postings are open to someone with a year of experience or less. High accessibility and low pay travel together, which is exactly the trade-off our recommender makes visible.

Rehearsal checklist

- ☐ Timed at **2:00 or under**
- ☐ You can say the independence finding — "where the jobs are is not where the money is" — as a clean one-liner
- ☐ You know the seniority ladder from memory (2,675 / 3,150 / 4,000 / 5,000 / 6,500)
- ☐ You never say "as you can see" — you say the finding first, then point
- ☐ Handover line to Speaker 5 practised